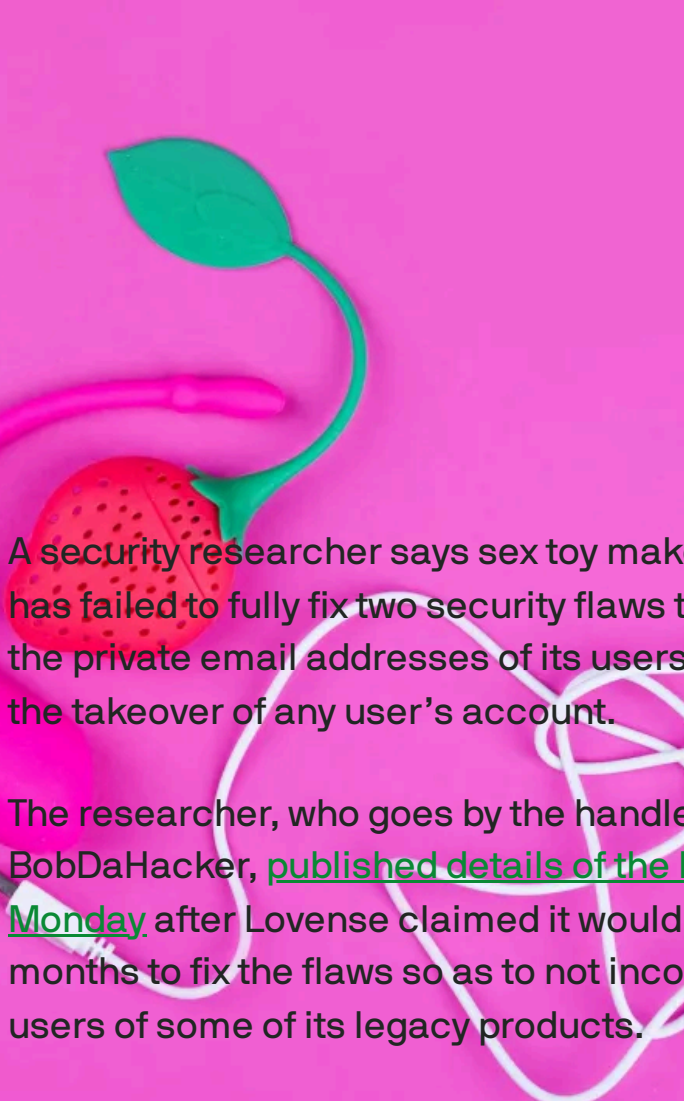


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SECURITY



**Sex toy maker Lovense
caught leaking users'
email addresses and
exposing accounts to
takeovers**



A security researcher says sex toy maker Lovense has failed to fully fix two security flaws that expose the private email addresses of its users and allow the takeover of any user's account.

The researcher, who goes by the handle BobDaHacker, [published details of the bugs on Monday](#) after Lovense claimed it would need 14 months to fix the flaws so as to not inconvenience users of some of its legacy products.

Lovense is one of the largest makers of internet-connected sex toys and is said to have [more than 20 million users](#). The company made headlines in 2023 for becoming one of the first sex toy makers to [integrate ChatGPT into its products](#).

But the inherent security risks in connecting sex toys to the internet can put users at risk of real-world harm if something goes wrong, including [device lock-ins](#) and [data privacy leaks](#).

BobDaHacker said they discovered that Lovense was leaking people's email addresses while using the app. Although other users' email addresses were not visible to users in the app, anyone using a network analysis tool to inspect the data flowing in and out of the app would see the other user's email address when interacting with them, such as muting them.

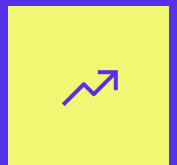
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By modifying the network request from a logged-in account, BobDaHacker said they could associate any Lovense username with their registered email address, potentially exposing any customer who has signed up to Lovense with an identifiable email address.

“This was especially bad for cam models who share their usernames publicly but obviously don’t want their personal emails exposed,” BobDaHacker wrote in their blog post.

TechCrunch verified this bug by creating a new account on Lovense and asking BobDaHacker to reveal our registered email address, which they did in about a minute. By automating the process with a computer script, the researcher said they could obtain a user’s email address in less than a second.

BobDaHacker said a second vulnerability allowed them to take over any Lovense user’s account using just their email address, which could be derived from the earlier bug. This bug lets anyone create authentication tokens for accessing a Lovense account without needing a password, allowing an attacker to remotely control the account as if they were the real user.

“Cam models use these tools for work, so this was a huge deal. Literally anyone could take over any account just by knowing the email address,” said BobDaHacker.

The bugs affect anyone with a Lovense account or device.

BobDaHacker disclosed the bugs to Lovense on March 26 via the [Internet of Dongs](#), a project that aims to improve the security and privacy of sex toys and helps [report and disclose flaws to device makers](#).

- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines
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According to BobDaHacker, they were awarded a total of \$3,000 via bug bounty site HackerOne. But after several weeks of back-and-forth disputing whether the bugs were actually fixed, the researcher went public this week after Lovense requested 14 months to fix the flaws. (Security researchers typically grant vendors three months or less to fix a security bug before going public with their findings.) The company told BobDaHacker in the same email that it decided against a “faster, one-month fix,” which would have required forcing customers using older products to upgrade their apps immediately.

The researcher notified the company ahead of disclosure, per an email seen by TechCrunch. BobDaHacker said in a blog post update on Tuesday that the bug may have been identified by another researcher as far back as September 2023, but the bug was allegedly closed without a fix.

Lovense did not respond to an email from TechCrunch sent prior to publication. After we published, a Lovense representative said the account takeover bug “has now been fully addressed” and that the email disclosure bug will be patched in an update expected to be “pushed to all users within the next week.” The representative would not commit to publicly notifying its customers about the bugs.

Updated with comment from Lovense.

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Zack Whittaker

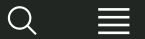
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Zack Whittaker is the security editor at TechCrunch. He can be reached via encrypted message at...

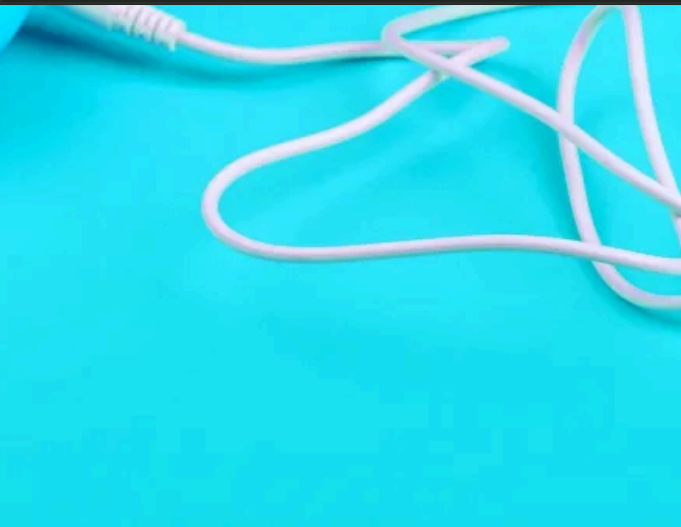
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after fixing security flaws that exposed users' data

Zack Whittaker — 7:55 AM PDT · August 1, 2025

IMAGE CREDITS:

EUGENIA SHULIM / GETTY IMAGES

Loveense, a maker of internet-connected sex toys, has confirmed it has [fixed a pair of security vulnerabilities](#) that exposed users' private email addresses and allowed attackers to remotely take over any user's account.

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While the company said the bugs were “fully resolved,” its chief executive is now considering taking legal action following the disclosure.

In [a statement](#) shared with TechCrunch, Lovense CEO Dan Liu said the sex toy maker was “investigating the possibility of legal action” in response to allegedly erroneous reports about the bug. When asked by TechCrunch, the company did not respond to clarify whether it was referring to media reports or to a security researcher’s disclosure.

Details of the bug emerged this week after a security researcher, who goes by the handle BobDaHacker, disclosed that they [reported the two security bugs](#) to the sex toy maker earlier this year. The researcher published their findings after Lovense claimed it would take 14 months to fully address the vulnerabilities rather than applying a “faster, one-month fix” that would have required alerting users to update their apps.

Lovense said in its statement, attributed to Liu, that the fixes put in place will require users to update their apps before they can resume using all of the app’s features.

In the statement, Liu claimed that there is “no evidence suggesting that any user data, including email addresses or account information, has been compromised or misused.” It’s not clear how Lovense came to this conclusion, given TechCrunch ([and other outlets](#)) verified the email disclosure bug by setting up a new account and asking the researcher to identify the associated email address.

TechCrunch asked Lovense what technical means, such as logs, the company has to determine if there was any compromise of users’ data, but a spokesperson did not respond.

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It's not unheard of for organizations to resort to legal demands and threats to try to block the disclosure of embarrassing security incidents, despite few rules or restrictions in the U.S. prohibiting such reporting.

Earlier this year, a U.S. independent journalist [rebuffed a legal threat](#) from a U.K. court injunction for accurately reporting a ransomware attack on U.K. private healthcare giant HCRG. In 2023, a county official in Hillsborough County, Florida, [threatened criminal charges against a security researcher](#) under the state's computer hacking laws for identifying and privately disclosing a security flaw in the county's court records system that exposed access to sensitive filings.

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Maker of 'smart' chastity cage left users' emails, passwords, and locations exposed

Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai

— 6:00 AM PDT · September 2, 2023

A company that makes a chastity device for people with a penis that can be controlled by a partner over the internet exposed users' email addresses, plaintext passwords, home addresses and IP addresses, and — in some cases — GPS coordinates, due to several flaws in its servers, according to a security researcher.

The researcher, who asked to remain anonymous because he wanted to separate his professional life from the kink-related work he does, said he gained access to a database containing records of more than 10,000 users, thanks to two vulnerabilities. The researcher said he exploited the bugs to see what data he could get access to. He also reached out to the company on June 17 alerting them of the issues in an attempt to get them to fix the vulnerabilities and protect their users' data, according to a

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Amanda Silberling,
Zack Whittaker
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Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai

screenshot of the email he sent and shared with TechCrunch.

As of publication, the company has yet to fix the vulnerabilities and did not respond to repeated requests for comment from TechCrunch.

“Everything’s just too easy to exploit. And that’s irresponsible,” the researcher told TechCrunch. “So my best hope is that they will contact either you or me and fix everything.”

Because the vulnerabilities are not fixed, TechCrunch is not identifying the company in order to protect its users, whose data is still at risk. TechCrunch also contacted the company’s web host, which said it would alert the device maker, as well as China’s Computer Emergency Response Team, or CERT, in an effort to also alert the company.

Given that he wasn’t getting any answers, on August 23 the researcher defaced the company’s homepage in an attempt to warn the company again, as well as its users.

“The site was disabled by a benevolent third party. [REDACTED] has left the site wide open, allowing any script kiddie to grab any and all customer information. This includes plaintext passwords and contrary to what [REDACTED] has claimed, also shipping addresses. You’re welcome!” the researcher wrote. “If you have paid for a physical unit and now cannot use it, I’m sorry. But there are thousands of people with accounts on here and I could not in good faith leave everything up for grabs.”

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Less than 24 hours later, the company removed the researcher's warning and restored the website. But the company did not fix the flaws, which remain present and exploitable.

In addition to the flaws that allowed him to gain access to the users' database, the researcher found that the company's website is also exposing logs of users' PayPal payments. The logs show the users' email addresses that they use on PayPal, and the day they made the payment.

The company sells a chastity cage for people with a penis that can be linked to an Android app (there is no iPhone app). Using the app, a partner — who could be anywhere in the world — can follow their partners' movements, given that the device

transmits precise GPS coordinates down to a few meters.

This is not the first time hackers exploit vulnerabilities in sex toys for men, in particular chastity cages. In 2021, [a hacker took control of people's devices and demanded a ransom](#).

“Your cock is mine now,” the hacker told one of the victims, according to a researcher who discovered the hacking campaign at the time.

The year before, security researchers [had warned the company](#) of serious flaws in its product that could be exploited by malicious hackers.

Over the years, other than actual data breaches, security researchers have found several security issues in [internet-connected sex toys](#). In 2016, researchers found a bug in a Bluetooth-powered “panty buster,” which allowed anyone to [control the sex toy](#) remotely over the internet. In 2017, a smart sex toy maker agreed to [settle a lawsuit](#) filed by two women who alleged the company spied on them by collecting and recording “highly intimate and sensitive data” of its users.

*Do you know of any similar hacks or data breaches?
From a non-work device, you can contact Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai securely on Signal at +1 917 257 1382, or via Telegram, Keybase, and Wire @lorenzofb, or email lorenzo@techcrunch.com.
You also can contact TechCrunch via [SecureDrop](#).*

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Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai

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Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai is a Senior Writer at TechCrunch, where he covers hacking, cybersecurity,...

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